First Product Fieldguide

A practical seven-page guide to choosing one useful problem, checking demand, drafting with AI and testing a launch on Threads.

Start with a useful outcome

You do not need a large following to start learning. You do need a useful solution, a way to reach relevant people and evidence that they want it. Publishing a file is a launch step; it is not proof of demand.

This guide helps you produce an idea brief, customer-research notes, a small resource outline, a listing draft and a measurable launch experiment. It does not promise income or a fixed completion time.

How to use this guide

• Choose a problem you understand through experience or direct research.

• Talk to potential users before investing heavily in a paid product.

• Use AI to organise and edit your knowledge. Verify its output yourself.

• Publish honest examples, measure visits and purchases, then improve.

What you need

A document editor, a way to create a PDF, a Threads profile and a checkout/delivery service such as Gumroad. Launchpad Studio is a separate online workspace accessed through your account; using an AI provider may require its own account or paid plan. Check the provider's current access terms.

Edition: 19 October 2026. Examples are hypothetical unless explicitly identified otherwise.

1. Choose one narrow problem

Choose a specific person, recurring task and concrete output. Avoid promising broad outcomes such as becoming wealthy, getting hired or going viral.

Worked example: a tutor worksheet kit

Person: independent English tutors preparing beginner lessons.
Problem: repeatedly formatting weekly practice worksheets.
Possible free resource: one editable worksheet with a completed example.
Possible paid product: a small set of editable worksheet layouts, answer-key examples and a walkthrough.

This is an illustrative idea, not validated demand. The tutor must check teaching accuracy, age suitability and any materials they include.

Write your idea brief

My audience is: _____
They struggle with this recurring task: _____
Their current workaround is: _____
My resource helps them produce: _____
My experience or evidence is: _____
What I still need to learn: _____

Keep the free and paid offers distinct

The free resource should solve one small task completely. The paid resource can add more use cases, editable assets, worked examples or guidance. Explain exactly what is included rather than promising a faster path to income.

2. Check demand before building

Have five conversations with people who match your audience. Ask about actual past behaviour before presenting your solution. Record answers with permission and remove identifying information from public examples.

Five useful questions

• When did this problem last happen? Walk me through it.

• How do you solve it now, and what is frustrating about that?

• How much time or money does the current process take?

• What have you tried or paid for already?

• Would you test this specific draft? What would make it worth buying?

What counts as evidence?

Specific repeated problems, observed use of a prototype and real purchase commitments are stronger evidence than likes or compliments. A free download shows interest in a free resource; it does not establish willingness to pay.

Conversation notes
Person / role (anonymised): _____
Last occurrence and workaround: _____
Exact problem in their words: _____
Prototype feedback: _____
Purchase / test commitment, if any: _____

Decide your next action

If the same problem appears repeatedly, build a small testable version. If people cannot describe the problem or already solve it easily, narrow or change the idea. Five conversations are a learning exercise, not statistical proof of a market.

3. Draft with AI, then verify

Paste these instructions into Gemini or another AI tool. Fill in the brackets first. Never include private customer details without permission.

Prompt 1: turn research into a scope

> My audience is [audience]. Their recurring problem is [problem]. My actual research notes are [anonymised notes]. Suggest a small resource with a concrete outcome, deliverables and exclusions. Distinguish evidence from assumptions. Ask about missing information; do not invent demand.

Prompt 2: create a useful outline

> Outline [resource title] for [audience]. Help them complete [task]. Include clear steps, one completed hypothetical example, a blank worksheet and a way to check their result. Use only these source facts: [facts]. Flag anything needing verification.

Prompt 3: draft and edit one section

> Draft [section] using my notes: [notes]. Use plain English, concrete examples and short steps. Do not invent personal stories, customer quotes or results. Then flag unsupported claims and unclear instructions. Keep placeholders visible for missing facts.

Your review checklist

- Check facts, calculations, permissions and source links.
- Complete the instructions yourself and ask a target user to try them.
- Replace generic advice with examples based on your own knowledge.

4. Package and publish honestly

Build a complete small resource

In the tutor example, the free download should contain the actual editable worksheet, a completed version and short instructions. The paid kit should include every asset listed on its sales page. A product idea or AI outline alone is not the finished kit.

A listing you can adapt

TITLE: [Specific resource and outcome]
FOR: [Specific audience]
HELPS WITH: [Concrete task]
YOU RECEIVE: [Exact files, examples and instructions]
PREVIEW: [Screenshot or demonstration link]
ACCESS: [File formats and how to open them]
LIMITATIONS: [What users still need to do]
PRICE / SUPPORT: [Accurate terms]

Gumroad publishing checklist

• Check account eligibility, payout availability and current platform terms.

• Upload the correct files; set the price and any pay-what-you-want options.

• Preview the listing and test the download/access experience.

• Link your own paid product from the free resource only when it is useful and ready.

Fees are not a flat 10%

As checked on 19 October 2026, Gumroad lists 10% + $0.50 per transaction for profile/direct-link sales and 30% for Discover sales. Check the current official pricing before setting your assumptions. No monthly platform fee does not mean no transaction costs.

Official source: gumroad.com/pricing

5. Show useful work on Threads

Give people a reason to follow: a specific audience, a useful recurring topic and visible examples of your work. Treat posting formats and posting times as experiments, not guaranteed distribution tricks.

Three posts to start with

DEMONSTRATION
For [audience], here is how [resource] helps with [task].
Input: [example]. Steps: [steps]. Output: [preview].
This is [a real / a hypothetical] example.

RESEARCH QUESTION
When you last faced [problem], how did you solve it?
What took the most time? I am testing [specific solution] and would like to understand your current process.

HONEST UPDATE
During [date range]: [views] views, [tracked visits] store visits, [free downloads] downloads and [paid purchases] purchases.
What I learned: [actual lesson]. My next change: [action].

Before you post

- Use your own URL and replace every bracketed placeholder.
- Do not copy a fictional personal success story as your own.
- Avoid false deadlines, unsupported earnings claims and repetitive plugs.
- Reply with specific help and questions, not just a link.

6. Run a launch experiment

Use this sequence at your own pace. A valuable product may take longer than a week to research, build and test.

• Record five customer conversations and choose one problem.

• Build a small draft and observe three relevant users trying it.

• Fix confusing instructions and verify every promised deliverable.

• Publish clear listings and a short product demonstration.

• Post several useful examples and use distinct tracking links.

• Compare posts at 24 and 72 hours; record store visits separately.

• Review paid purchases and successful usage before building more.

Measure the complete journey

Views -> relevant store visits -> downloads / purchases -> successful use. Compare the same dates and traffic sources. Views are not unique people, interactions can repeat, and visits to two products may overlap. Small samples cannot establish a reliable conversion rate.

Optional companion: Launchpad Studio

The paid companion offers eight topic-example sets, editable AI prompts, 30 different post starters, listing drafts, your own product-link fields, a hypothetical scenario calculator, a launch checklist and saved account progress.

Launchpad Studio is accessed inside your signed-in platform library. Your progress is saved to your account; no app ZIP or HTML download is provided. It does not run AI, validate demand, publish posts or guarantee income. You must customise drafts and verify your work. You can complete this guide without buying the Studio.

First Product Fieldguide: USD 5. Launchpad Studio: USD 19. Each is a separate one-time purchase. Return to your platform library to see current access and purchase options.